

Last week we saw where GRACE was FIRST mentioned in the Bible: Genesis 6:5...
“Noah found GRACE in the EYES of the Lord.”

But is that really where GRACE was first mentioned.

Names are a big deal in the Bible.

When you said a name, you actually were saying a sentence in those days.

And a sense of destiny was attached to a name.

The name became the magnetic north for that individual.

A name wasn't just handed out. It had tremendous importance.

It was usually a kind of prophecy that the parents gave with a great sense of what God was saying.

So when they gave it it was with a great sense of destiny.

Their name was an actual sound that made a sentence and pointed to what the parent believed the child was becoming.

EXAMPLES:

Daniel: God is my judge

Ezekiel: God strengthens

Isaiah: God is salvation

Samuel: God has heard

Benjamin: Son of my right hand

Immanuel: God is with us

Abraham: Father of many

**The name contained the hope of the parent for the child.
Their name was their magnetic north.
It was drawing him on.**

So...let's look at a list of names in Genesis Chapter 5.
One chapter prior to chapter 6...where GRACE was first mentioned.

Adam: man, common, earthly man
Seth: appointed, set
Enos: weakness, sin, sickness
Cainan (Kenan): possession, mourned
Mahalaleel: The praise of God; the blessed God
Jared: descended, came down
Enoch: consecrated; initiated
Methuselah: by His death to send
Lamech: with power to the poor and oppressed
Noah: comfort; rest
Shem: the celebrated name
Ham: darkness & heat
Japheth: enlarged place

When you put the meanings of these names into a sentence you have:

Man, common, earthly man, having appointed or set weakness, sin and sin for his possession, mourned.

But the praise of God, the blessed God, descended. He came down, and consecrated and initiated, by His death to send with power to the poor and oppressed, comfort and rest through the celebrated Name. He redeemed us from darkness and heat and brought us to an enlarged place.

It demonstrates in the earliest chapters of the Book of Genesis that God had already laid out His plan of redemption for the predicament or problem with sin that mankind suffered. It is a love story, written in blood on a wooden cross almost 2,000 years ago.

You were never an afterthought to God. He has always had His eyes upon you, even before you were formed in your mother's womb!

This also completely undermines any notion that God's plan of redemption was simply a knee-jerk reaction to the surprise of Adam's failure.

When did God first begin His work in you? Ephesians 1:4 tells us it was literally "before the foundation of the world!"

14 Generations: 3x's
14 means salvation and deliverance
3 means fullness and perfection.

Matthew then makes a curious summarizing statement:

"So all the generations from Abraham to David were 14 generations; and from David until the exile to Babylon, fourteen generations; and from the exile to Babylon until the Christ, fourteen generations." (Mt 1:17)

It may come as a startling fact, but by modern methods, this is not historically accurate. There were more generations than Matthew reported (for example, three between Joram and Uzziah in verse 8).

This is a curated list, remember? It isn't about genealogical precision, it is about something much greater. Summarizing in this way was

an acceptable and understood practice at that time.

Matthew is looking back over history and saying everything that happened before this points to something new, something better.

In Leviticus we find the answer to Matthew's mystery equation. There is an extensive description of an ordinance from the Lord that becomes an integral part of Israel's culture and life. The Lord ordained times of rest and liberty known as Sabbath years and Jubilees. This is how it worked:

"You may sow your field for six years, and you may prune your vineyard and gather its produce for six years. But there will be a Sabbath of complete rest for the land in the seventh year, a Sabbath to the Lord: you are not to sow your field or prune your vineyard." (Lev 25:3-4)

So a Sabbath year came every 7 years; it was like the ultimate weekend and it lasted all year. Then, there was Jubilee:

“You are to count seven sabbatical years, seven times seven years, so that the time period of the seven sabbatical years amounts to forty-nine... You are to consecrate the fiftieth year and proclaim freedom in the land for all its inhabitants.” (Lev 25: 8, 10)

The instructions for Jubilee go on for forty-four more verses, and they include some very surprising rules!

God speaks of debts being erased (entirely forgiven!), property returned, slaves freed, captives released, it is an incredible thought! What weeping and rejoicing must have taken place over the surge of healing and justice that came after forty-nine (7×7) long years!

Do you see the trend? The number seven is emphasized again and again in the Old Testament, and represents completion, perfection and fulfillment.

Matthew is declaring that up until Jesus there were six sets of seven generations [$(2 \times 7 = 14) \times 3$], and the coming of Jesus is the initiation of the seventh set of seven: 7×7 !

Jesus's birth brings us eternal rest, forever freedom, and erases our greatest debt— He is the Jubilee of Jubilees!

EXTRA NOTES

Another list with the meanings:

Adam. Adam's name means "*man.*" As the first man that seems straight forward.

Seth. Adam's son was Seth, which means "*appointed.*"

Enosh. Seth's son was Enosh which means "*mortal, frail, or miserable.*"

Kenan. Enosh's son was Kenan, which means "*sorrow.*"

Mahalalel. Kenan's son was Mahalalel which means "*blessed or praise.*" "El" means *God*.

Combined, his name means "*Blessed God.*"

Jared. Mahalalel's son was Jared, which comes from root verb "yaradh"- "*shall come down.*"

Enoch. Jared's son was named Enoch, which means "*teaching, or commencement*"

Methuselah. Enoch's son Methuselah, comes from two words. Muth means "*death*", shalach "*to bring*"

Combined, Methuselah's name means "*his death shall bring*"

Lamech. Methuselah's son was Lamech, a root still evident today "*lament(ation)*"

Lamech means *“despairing.”*

Noah. Lamech’s son is Noah which is derived from “nacham”
– *“to bring relief, comfort”*

Put It All Together:

Adam	Man
Seth	Appointed
Enosh	Mortal
Kenan	Sorrow
Mahalalel	The Blessed God
Jared	Shall Come Down
Enoch	Teaching
Methuselah	His Death Shall Bring
Lamech	The Despairing
Noah	Rest or Comfort

“Man is appointed mortal sorrow; but the Blessed God shall come down teaching that His death shall bring the despairing rest or comfort.”